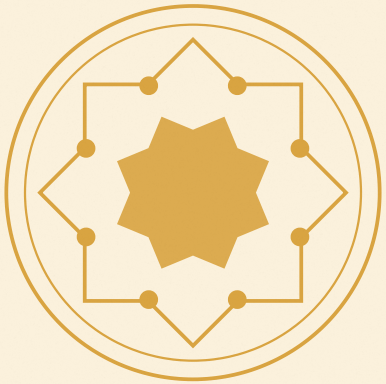
STORIES FROM THE QURAN · 3

Yusuf and the Eleven Stars

يوسف والكواكب





From the Quran

إِذْ قَالَ يُوسُفُ لِأَبِيهِ يَٰٓأَبَتِ إِنِّى رَأَيْتُ أَحَدَ عَشَرَ كَوْكَبًا وَٱلشَّمْسَ وَٱلْقَمَرَ رَأَيْتُهُمْ لِى سَٰجِدِينَ

[Of these stories mention] when Joseph said to his father, "O my father, indeed I have seen [in a dream] eleven stars and the sun and the moon; I saw them prostrating to me."

Yusuf 12:4 · Saheeh International

One night a boy named Yusuf (peace be upon him) had a wonderful dream.

“Father,” he said, “I saw eleven stars, and the sun and the moon. I saw them bowing down to me!”



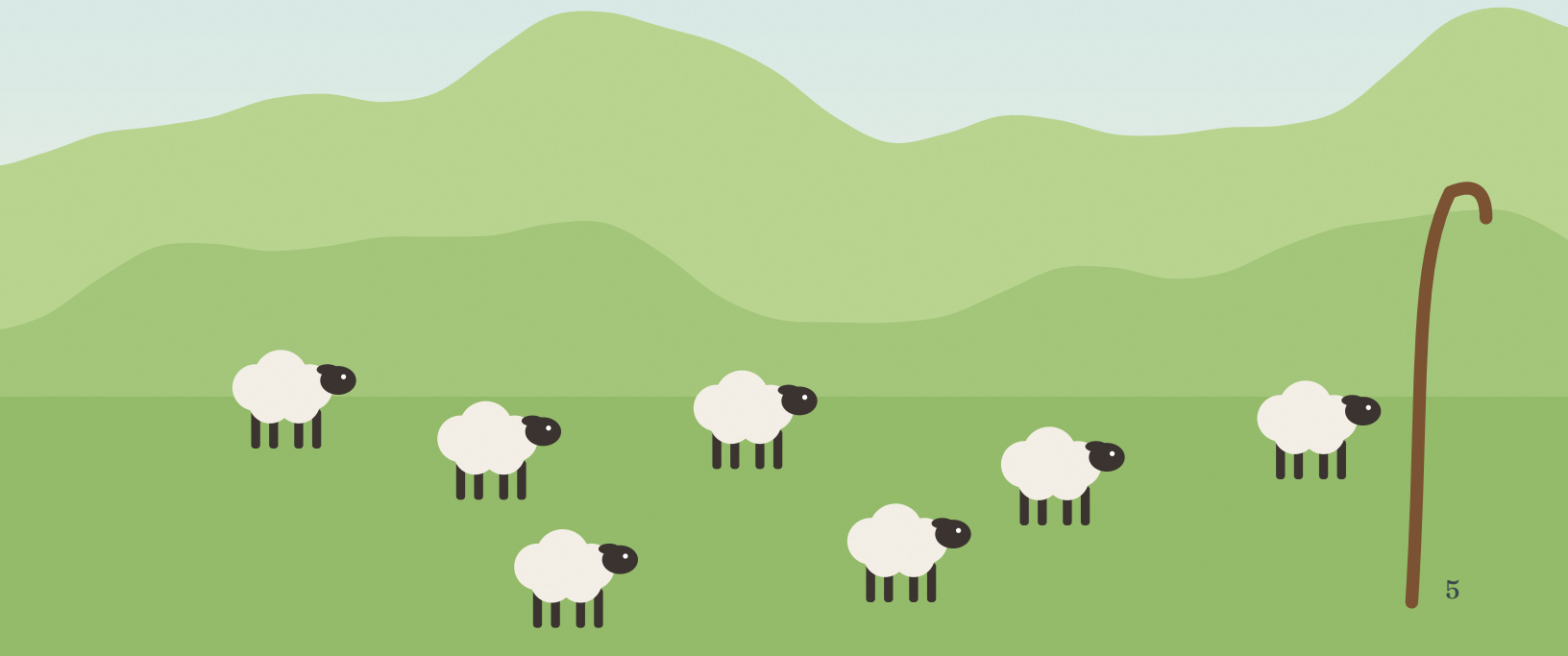
His father was Prophet Ya'qub. He understood that Allah had chosen Yusuf for something special.

"My son," he said gently, "do not tell your brothers about your dream. They may become jealous and plot against you."



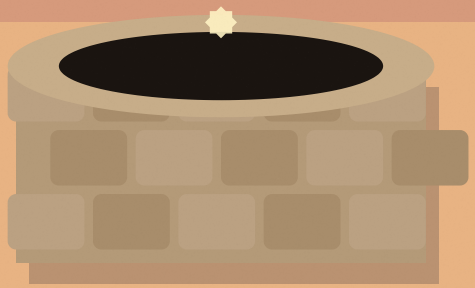
Yusuf had ten older brothers, and they were jealous. “Our father loves Yusuf more than us,” they grumbled.

So they asked their father, “Send Yusuf out with us tomorrow, to run and play.”



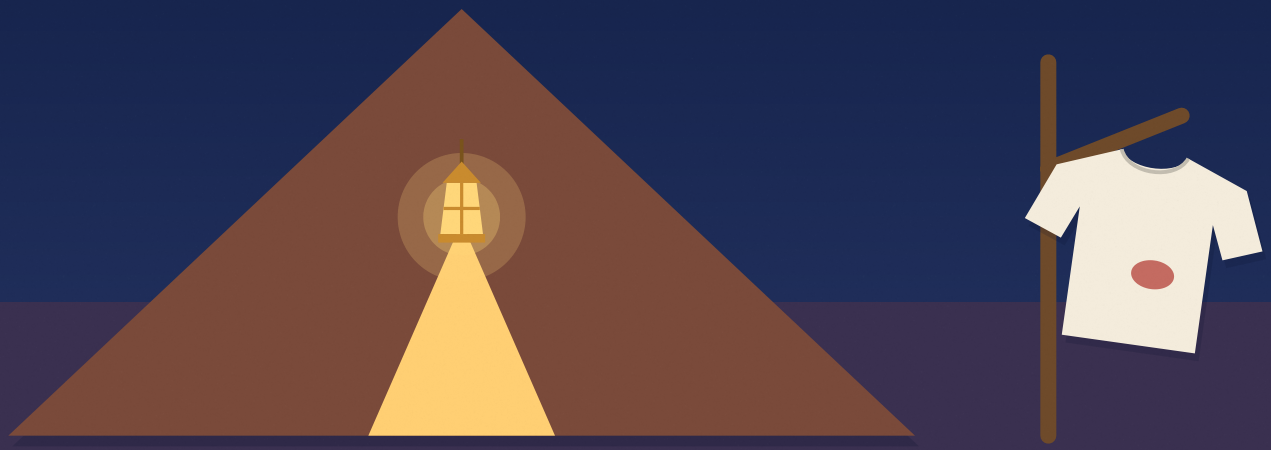
But when they were far from home, they threw Yusuf into the bottom of a deep well.

Down in the dark, Allah told Yusuf: “One day you will remind them of what they did, when they do not know who you are.”



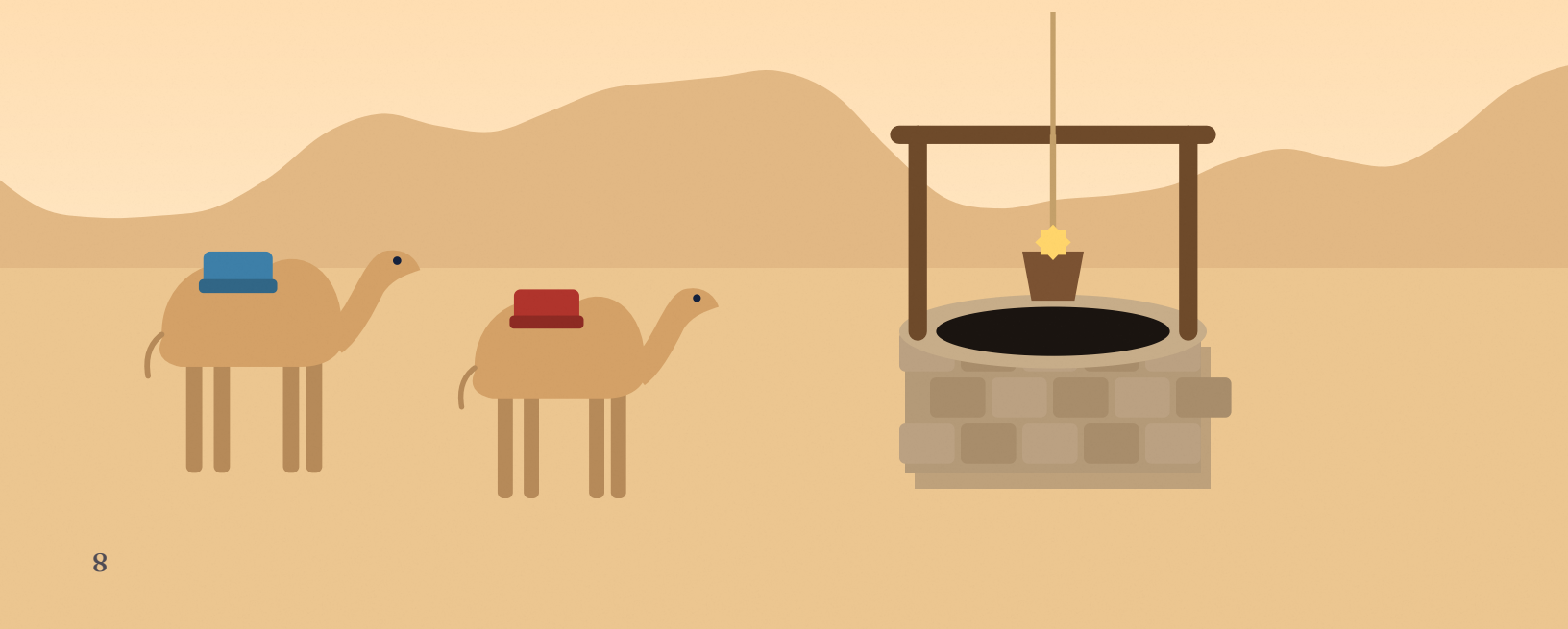
That night the brothers came home crying. They held up Yusuf's shirt, stained with false blood. "A wolf ate him!"

But Ya'qub knew they were not telling the truth. "Beautiful patience," he said. "Allah is the One I ask for help."



Then a caravan of travellers came by and stopped at the well. One of them let down his bucket, and up came… a boy!

“Good news!” he called. “Look what I found!”

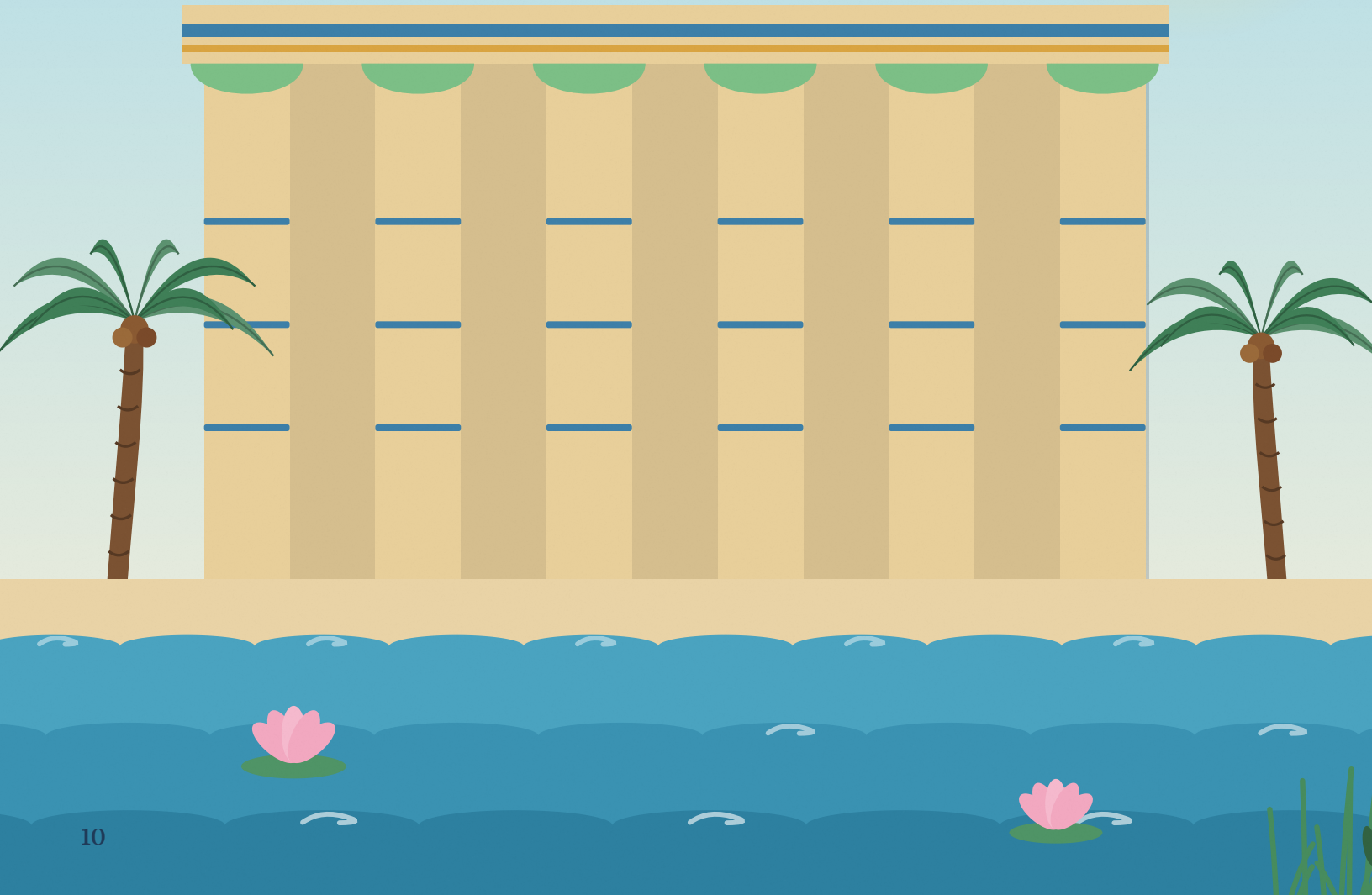


The travellers sold Yusuf for a few silver coins, and carried him far away, all the way to Egypt.



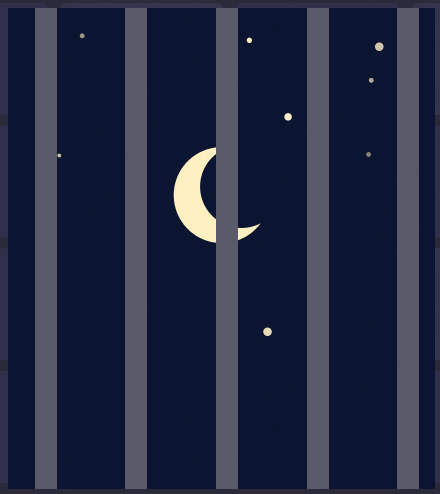
In Egypt, an important man bought him. “Look after him well,” he told his wife. “He may be useful to us, or we could adopt him as our son.”

Yusuf grew up wise and kind, and Allah gave him knowledge.



When Yusuf was a young man, some people told lies about him. His shirt, torn from behind, showed that he had done nothing wrong.

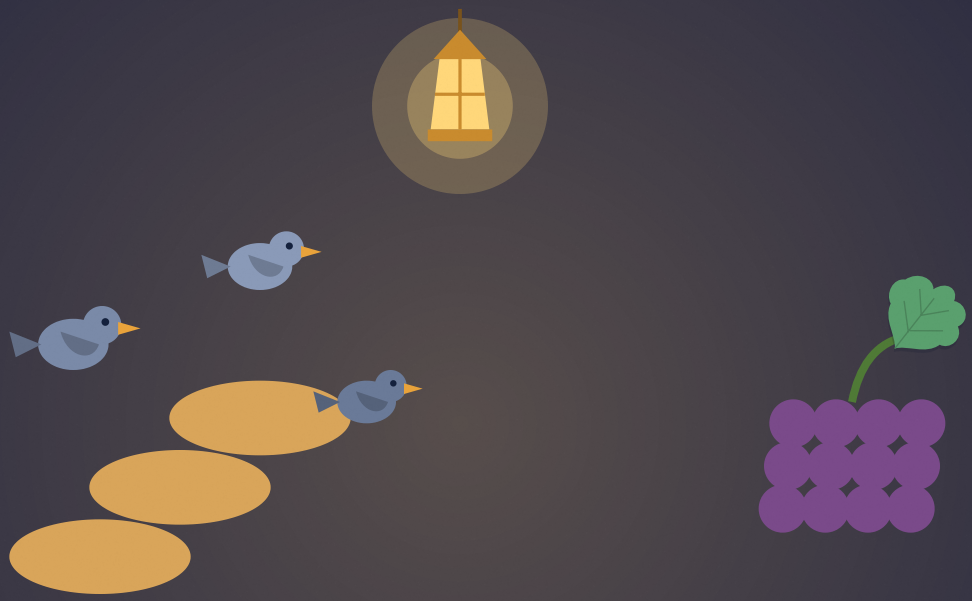
But still they put him in prison.





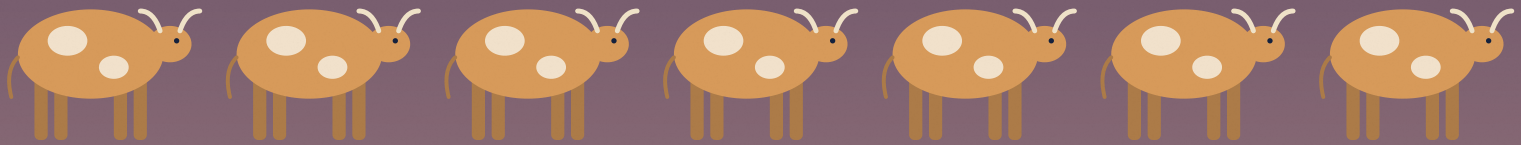
In prison, two men told Yusuf their dreams. One dreamed of pressing grapes. The other dreamed of carrying bread on his head, while birds pecked at it.

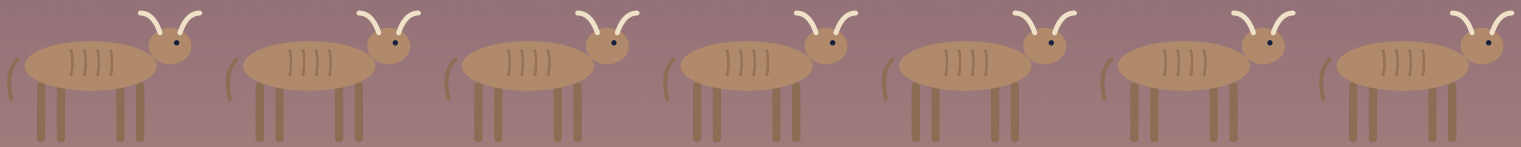
Yusuf told them what the dreams meant, and taught them about Allah, the One.

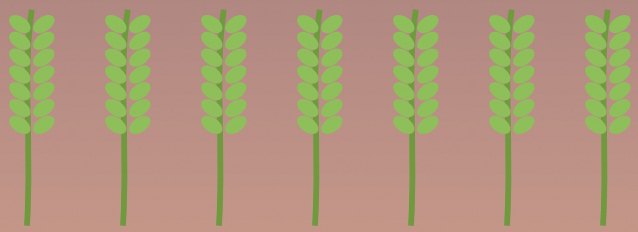


One day the king of Egypt had a strange dream: seven fat cows were eaten by seven thin cows. And there were seven green ears of wheat, and seven dry ones.

No one could explain it, until someone remembered Yusuf.

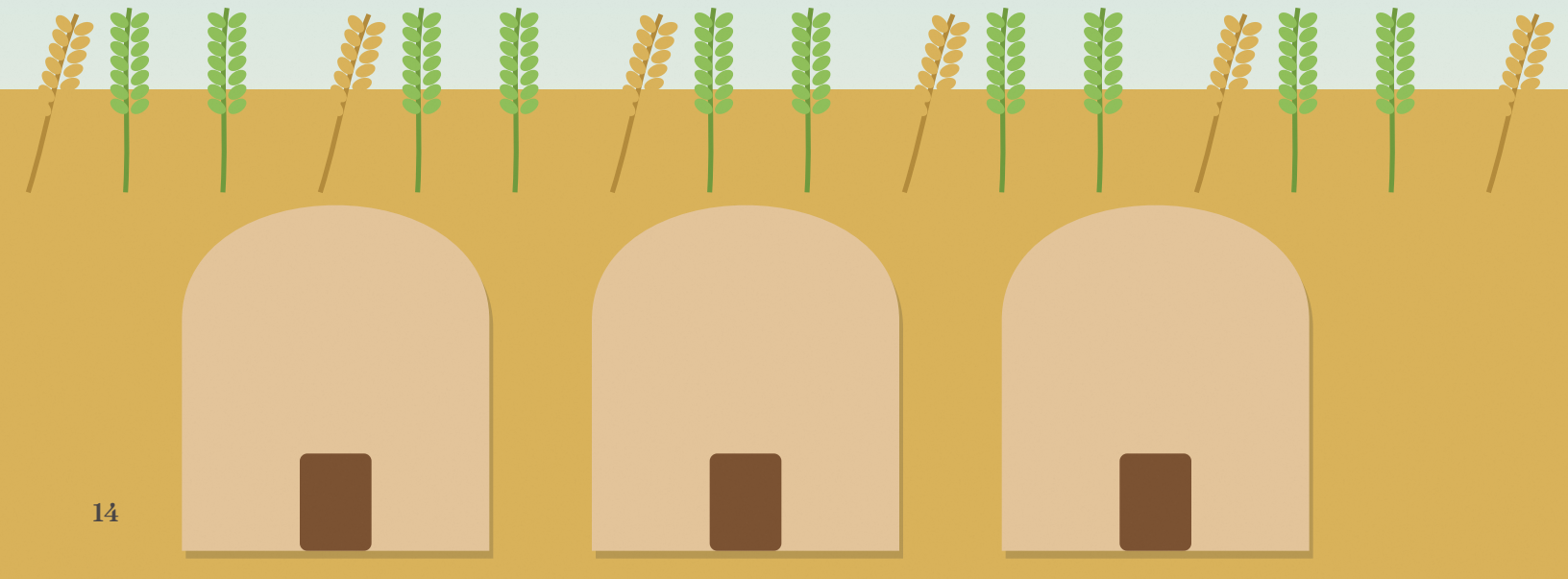






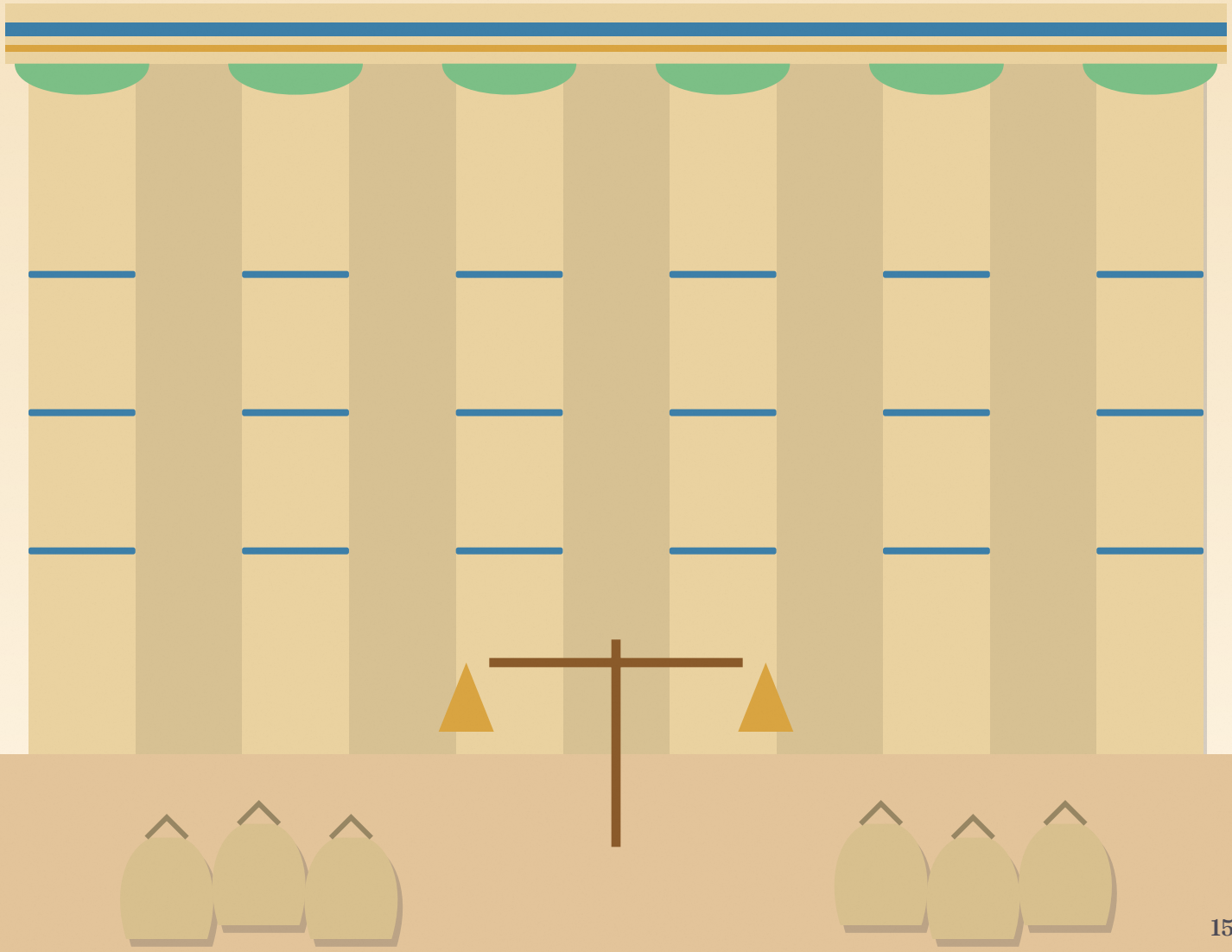


“For seven years,” said Yusuf, “plant and harvest. Keep the grain in its ears, except a little to eat. Then seven hard years will come, and you will eat what you saved.”



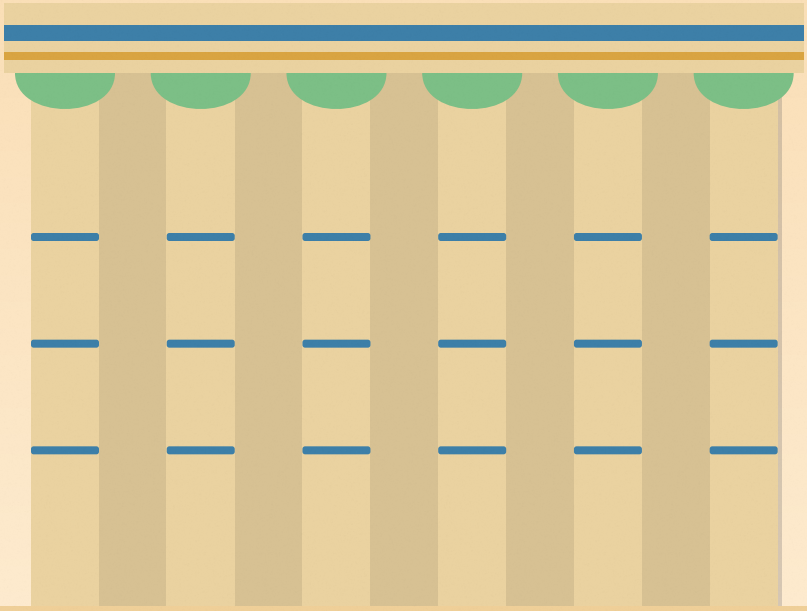
The king set Yusuf free. “Put me in charge of the storehouses,” said Yusuf. “I will guard them well.”

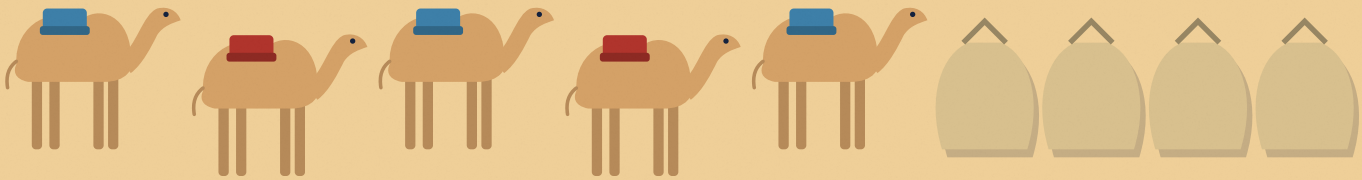
And he did.



The hard years came, and people travelled from far away to buy grain. One day ten brothers arrived from Yusuf's homeland.

Yusuf knew them at once. They did not know him at all.





At last he told them: “I am Yusuf!”

His brothers were ashamed and afraid. But Yusuf said: “No blame on you today. May Allah forgive you. He is the most merciful of all.”





Old Ya'qub had cried so much for Yusuf that he could no longer see.
"Take my shirt," said Yusuf, "and lay it over my father's face."

When they did, Ya'qub could see again!



The whole family came to Egypt. Yusuf welcomed his parents, and all eleven brothers bowed down before him.

“Father,” said Yusuf, “this is the meaning of my dream from long ago. My Lord has made it come true.”



Words to remember

Two short sayings from Surah Yusuf. One is for waiting. One is for forgiving.

فَصَبْرٌ جَمِيلٌ

Fa-ṣabrun jamīl

So, beautiful patience.

لَا تَثْرِيبَ عَلَيْكُمُ ٱلْيَوْمَ

Lā tathrība ʻalaykumul-yawm

No blame on you today.

From Surah Yusuf, 12:18 and 12:92

What does the story teach us?

Be patient.
Ya'qub waited many years, with beautiful patience.

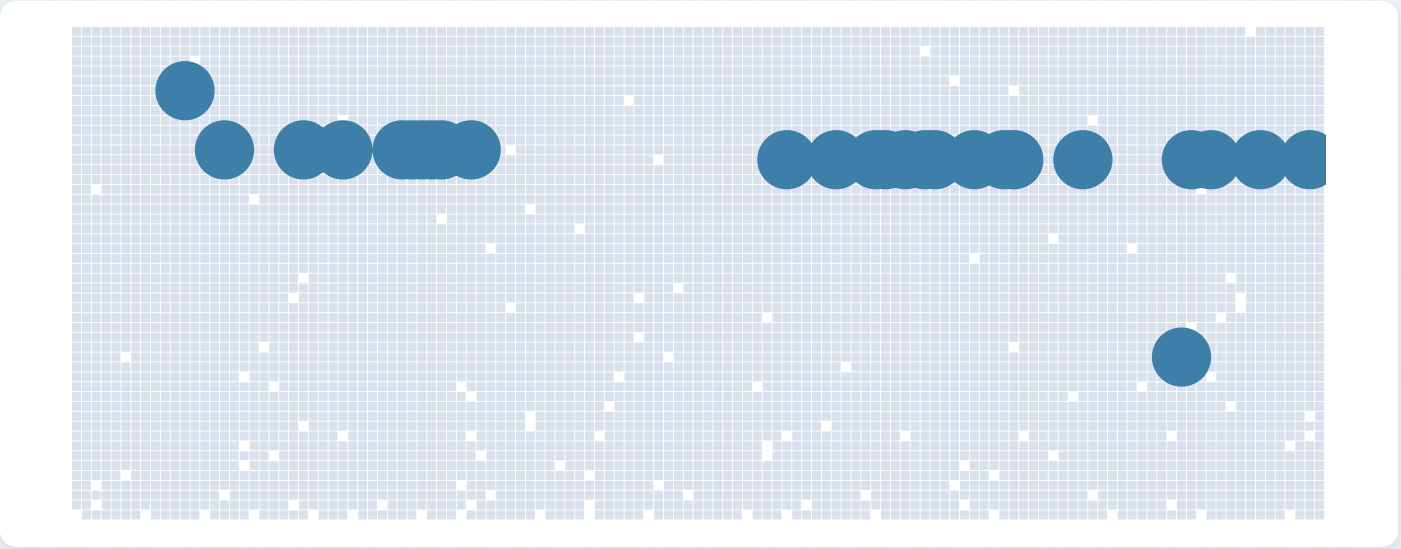
Forgive.
Yusuf forgave his brothers, even after what they did.

Allah's plan is best.
The well, Egypt, even prison: each step led to the dream coming true.

Tell the truth.
The brothers' lie did not fool their father.

Did you know?

Yusuf's name appears **27** times, and **25** of them are in one surah. See how the dots crowd together!



Every verse of the Quran is one tiny square, starting at the top right like a page of the Quran. Each dot is a verse that names Yusuf.

Surah Yusuf, number 12, tells his whole story from beginning to end in 111 verses. The Quran calls it "the best of stories" (12:3).

Look closer

Some pictures hide a secret from the Quran itself. Go back and find them.

p. 3, 19	The same sky: eleven stars, the sun and the moon. The story ends where it began (12:4 and 12:100), like the ring shapes in the Quran Atlas.
p. 7, 11, 18	The shirt appears three times: with false blood (12:18), torn from behind (12:25–28), and the shirt that healed (12:93).
p. 7	The wolf-shaped cloud. The wolf is named three times, all in this surah (12:13, 14, 17), and it never did anything at all.
p. 7, 17	“Beautiful patience”: Ya‘qub says it twice, in 12:18 and again in 12:83.
p. 13	Count them: seven fat cows, seven thin cows, seven green ears and seven dry ones (12:43).
p. 6	The little star in the well is Allah’s promise to Yusuf (12:15).

For parents

Where the story is told. Surah Yusuf 12:4–101. Almost the whole surah is this one story.

Told in simple words. This is a retelling for young children, not a translation. The episode with the wife of the Egyptian official (12:23–34) is told only as "some people told lies about him"; you can tell it more fully when your child is older. The number of coins (12:20 says only "a few") is left uncounted.

The pictures. By custom, no prophet is drawn, and in this series no person at all. The pictures show the places, the light and the creatures, so your child can picture the story around them.

Talk about it. The brothers were jealous. What does jealousy feel like, and what helps it go away?

Illustrators welcome. These first pictures are a starting point. Artists are invited to redraw any book; the Books page of the Quran Atlas has a brief for every page.

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